are also predicted to increase; the prices of basic necessities, including food items, are increasing as well.

PTI's attempt to fix the taxation system has yielded less than favourable results. Far from punishing tax evaders, taxes levied on the salaried class and on everyday items, including medicine, has shot up. Under this government, Pakistanis will be faced with severe economic difficulties, at least for the foreseeable future. While the PTI argues that such difficulties are an outcome of the corruption and inefficiency of the previous governments, an outcome that is unavoidable given the weak political, economic and social infrastructure of the country, the PTI government is going further into debt, without providing any sufficient safeguards to the 'second youngest population in the world'.[1]

The security state under the PTI government has also intensified its reach, with journalists and media coming under greater surveillance and censorship. In June 2019 the Pakistan Electronic Media Regulatory Authority (PEMRA) issued a notice to all satellite television channels advising them against airing 'satirical content' that mocks political leadership and personalities or law enforcement agencies. Reporters Without Borders (RSF) reported how three Pakistani news channels were 'suspended from cable networks at the behest of the authorities in reprisal for broadcasting an opposition leader's news conference' (RSF 2019). The opposition leader in this case was Maryam Nawaz, the daughter of the imprisoned former prime minister Nawaz Sharif. BBC Monitoring reported how under the new government media censorship has moved beyond harassing individual journalists, to pressurizing 'organisations that are seen to be critical of the establishment' (Mushtaq 2019). This was also echoed by the Pakistan Federal Union of Journalists (PFUJ) that held nationwide protests in July 2019 against censorship and budget cuts that resulted in journalists being laid off. The protest highlighted not just the issue of increasing censorship but also that 'the country's newly-elected government is slashing its advertising budget, squeezing a key source of revenue for private newspapers and TV stations' (Dawn News 2019). Journalists and human rights activists are also targeted on social media, in one case for putting up 'defamatory and obnoxious posts' on Twitter that were 'against the "judiciary, government institutions and intelligence agencies"' (See CPJ 2019).

Despite this current economic crisis and the increasing surveillance and monitoring of journalists, human rights activists, students and academics in 'naya' Pakistan, the new government has attempted to normalize relations with its neighbours and build stronger partnerships with former allies. Two cases